A WORLD THAT REMEMBERS

ASHENOATH

20 creatures. 12 people. One inhabited world.

Original illustrated asset designs with narrative, encounter and modeling specifications.

2D art + 3D preproduction | Version 1.0 | 29 October 2026

What you are holding

DELIVERED

32 individual PNG sheets, a dossier for every subject, machine-readable data, original generation prompts, an offline catalogue and production notes. Each design has a role in the world rather than functioning as a cosmetic variant.

USE IT TODAY

Review art direction; show the bestiary and cast; commission a model, a rig or an animation set from an exact brief. The PNGs retain their original generated resolution. The catalogue links to each master and dossier.

3D PRODUCTION BOUNDARY

These are illustrated design sheets. They are not meshes, UV maps, material maps, skin weights or animation clips. A front and rear painting can disagree at small details; resolve those differences before modeling. No Godot integration or runtime performance is claimed.

WHAT IS ESTABLISHED

All 12 character identities and 10 creature identities exist in the inspected project. Known ages, occupations, clothing language and meaningful objects were preserved. Every new appearance detail and forward story extension is a proposal.

WHAT IS PROTECTED

The player is not renamed. Halvern remains a bounded memory. Missing travelers are not revived. The White Hart remains the sole complete supernatural witness. Current quest and save contracts remain authoritative.

VISUAL DIRECTION

Grounded anatomy, readable material differences, working clothes, distinct faces and believable weight. Greyfen uses repaired cloth, worn timber, dull iron and warm linen. Vargan arranges related materials more formally. Strong design comes from proportion and occupation before decoration.

The bestiary / 1

Stable asset IDs connect art, dossiers and production data.

M01 **Ghoulkin** EXISTING

Opening skirmisher that teaches short attack commitments and separation of a small pack.

M02 **Wychwood Stalker** EXISTING

A pursuit predator that makes looking behind, trap placement and safe handling of evidence meaningful.

M03 **Bog Wretch** EXISTING

Early boss whose protected core teaches exposure and a clear punish window.

M04 **Gravebound Knight** EXISTING

Threshold guard that teaches patience, flank access and armor preparation.

M05 **The Bell-Eater** EXISTING

Cemetery boss with Harnessed, Unchained and Hollow Bell phases.

M06 **Rootbound Colossus** EXISTING

Spatial boss whose root lanes and exposed-heart recovery teach deliberate repositioning.

M07 **Ashwing Carrion Drake** EXISTING

A directional-pressure boss with perch destruction and grounded vulnerability.

M08 **White Hart Avatar** EXISTING

Final witness and moral culmination; physical confrontation and a peaceful resolution are both already supported.

M09 **Silt-Maw** PROPOSED

Burrow ambush with terrain reading and a route-repair objective.

M10 **Millback** PROPOSED

Armor-facing puzzle around the working sluice and a moving wheel.

The bestiary / 2

Stable asset IDs connect art, dossiers and production data.

M11 Glassmoth — PROPOSED

Light-guided navigation and a short dust-pressure encounter that rewards restraint.

M12 Knell Leech — PROPOSED

Ceiling-to-floor ambush that teaches checking overhead and interrupting a latch before contact.

M13 Hearthscale — PROPOSED

Armor-direction and environmental temperature encounter around a working kiln.

M14 Gallows Weaver — PROPOSED

Anchor-cutting traversal and an arena whose geometry can be deliberately changed.

M15 Reed Choir — PROPOSED

Timed pressure pulses and a navigational clue through marsh water routes.

M16 Inkblind — PROPOSED

Quiet navigation and document rescue under local pressure, with a visible feeding process.

M17 Cairn Mother — PROPOSED

A moving obstruction and stewardship choice, with defensive rather than predatory aggression.

M18 Shroud Swimmer — PROPOSED

Shallow-water displacement encounter with visible surface trails and a rescue alternative.

M19 Wychwood Raider — EXISTING

Feinter that teaches recognition of a false opening and protection of carried evidence.

M20 Wychwood Brute — EXISTING

Space-controlling heavy that tests commitment and route awareness rather than chase speed.

The people of the road

Stable asset IDs connect art, dossiers and production data.

C01 **Sister Anwen** EXISTING

Shrine keeper; the human gateway into the failed containment and the village's conscience

C02 **Rook** EXISTING

Traveler, trader and carrier of inherited family testimony

C03 **Mira Fen** EXISTING

Herbalist whose useful remedies expose the cost of inherited wrongdoing

C04 **Blacksmith Tor** EXISTING

The maker who must replace useful stolen iron without leaving the village helpless

C05 **Widow Elna** EXISTING

The keeper of ordinary love who refuses to let grief excuse the closed gate

C06 **Farmer Toma** EXISTING

A father whose secret protection creates a danger his neighbors must also bear

C07 **Captain Senn** EXISTING

An accountable military participant whose present raids repeat the language of protection

C08 **Lord Edric Vargan** EXISTING

Competent ruler whose emergency relief makes coercion appear reasonable

C09 **Record Keeper Vale** EXISTING

The custodian who kept both orders and must now make preservation mean access

C10 **Steward Merrow** EXISTING

The administrator whose routine turns an unjust policy into empty bowls

C11 **Nessa** EXISTING

The baker whose practical authority makes promises answer to meals

C12 **Nera** EXISTING

Crossing keeper whose safety work must survive both guilt and collapsed authority

Every design has a job

Proposed extensions connect the new creatures to the established human story.

NAMES AND THE DISTURBED GROUND

Anwen, Elna and Vale connect Ghoulkin, the Bell-Eater and Knell Leeches to the handling of graves and records. Objects can corroborate events; no new creature becomes an omniscient witness.

FOOD, CRAFT AND RESTITUTION

Toma, Nessa, Tor and Merrow connect the Millback, Hearthscale and Silt-Maw to water, fuel and food. Repairing a route changes somebody's working day and provides a reason to return.

ROADS AND THE PEOPLE USING THEM

Rook and Nera connect the Stalker, Raider, Brute, Shroud Swimmer and Gallows Weaver to movement, lost cargo and public safety. Solving an encounter changes access rather than only awarding loot.

WHAT SURVIVES IN THE ARCHIVE

Vale, Elna and Edric connect the Glassmoth, Inkblind, Cairn Mother and Gravebound Knight to seals, boundaries, custody and contradictory orders. Documentary evidence still needs interpretation.

CARE UNDER PRESSURE

Mira and Anwen connect the Bog Wretch and Reed Choir to treatment and marsh ecology. Scarcity complicates care without turning vulnerable people into a resource.

THE GREAT WITNESSES AND BOSSES

The Rootbound Colossus, Ashwing and White Hart preserve the campaign's major thresholds. The final complete witness remains unique. Boss encounters can transform a place and clarify a responsibility.

Ghoulkin

Established creature / new visual design | Greyfen cemetery; Wychwood road margins

VISUAL IDENTITY

A wiry, long-armed humanoid scavenger, 1.63 metres upright but habitually crouched. Its oversized jaw grows naturally from a low wedge-shaped skull. The face is stretched living tissue rather than an exposed skull: small milk-grey eyes, broad flattened nose, split calloused lips. Thin charcoal hair grows unevenly along the spine and forearms. Peat-grey skin has bruised umber joints, dried mud in the folds and a subtle cold sheen. Powerful hands have four blunt digging fingers and a thumb; the feet remain plantigrade. A compact rib cage and strong haunches support its forward posture. No clothes, weapons, horns, viscera or ornamental spikes.

SCALE & SURFACE

1.63 m height. canonical runtime height. lower habitual crouch. peat-stained skin, sparse coarse hair, blunt dirty keratin nails, cold wet mud

ANIMATION / RIG

BIPED_GHOUL; retain the existing humanoid contact contract where possible. crouch_scavenge, token_notice, rake_windup, rake_recover

ENCOUNTER

Opening skirmisher that teaches short attack commitments and separation of a small pack.

READ THE ATTACK

The shoulder dips and the jaw opens before a short forward rake; a token attracts a clearly visible head turn before redirection.

PLAYER ANSWER

Use the normal sword after the committed rake, avoid chasing the retreat, and control space between pack members. Preserve the existing normal-sword weakness.

WHY IT BELONGS

Connects the first disturbed graves to missing names through recoverable scraps and track direction. The player learns that evidence has physical effects in the world.

ALTERNATIVE RESOLUTION

A proposed optional diversion with an already-understood token can avoid an incidental pack. Do not bypass mandatory existing combat objectives or consume unique evidence.

Wychwood Stalker

Established creature / new visual design | Wychwood; evidence trail beyond the road attack

VISUAL IDENTITY

A forest predator built around a low, folded bipedal frame, 1.60 metres at its alert height. The long forearms hang almost to the ground while narrow haunches fold beneath a deep but thin chest. Its head is a small forward wedge with dark recessed eyes, a blunt muzzle and short interlocking teeth. Moss-black coarse hair lies in directional bands across slate-green leathery skin, breaking up the body without turning it into foliage. Three long load-bearing fingers and a smaller opposing digit end in climbing claws. The shoulders rise into muscular ridges rather than horns. Healed trap scars cross one shin; no wings, antlers or costume pieces.

SCALE & SURFACE

1.6 m height. canonical runtime height. slate-green hide, coarse moss-black hair, worn climbing claws, healed scar tissue

ANIMATION / RIG

BIPED_STALKER; long-armed biped with specialized crouch and shoulder poses. circle_left, circle_right, rear_lunge, trap_inspect

ENCOUNTER

A pursuit predator that makes looking behind, trap placement and safe handling of evidence meaningful.

READ THE ATTACK

It stops circling, lowers its leading hand and fixes both shoulders toward the target before a lateral lunge.

PLAYER ANSWER

Use iron traps in a new position after its first avoidance response; rotate to keep the creature in view and punish a failed committed lunge.

WHY IT BELONGS

Its route and fixation on disturbed objects help the player reconstruct where evidence was moved, rather than simply adding another forest fight.

ALTERNATIVE RESOLUTION

Proposed incidental encounters may be evaded along open sightlines; do not add a quest-solving negotiation or give it reliable testimony.

Bog Wretch

Established creature / new visual design | Wychwood northern clearing; memory-rich watercourse roots

VISUAL IDENTITY

A 1.72-metre marsh revenant with an unusually broad pelvis, heavy lowered belly and long soft arms that brace its weight in the mud. Its face is small and recessed beneath a thick folded brow; the mouth is a horizontal slit with worn dark teeth. Waterlogged olive hide gathers into leathery breathing folds along the flanks. Thin root fibres bind the upper torso around a dim, solid amber core, visible only through a natural gap in the protective folds. Long webbed fingers contrast with broad short toes. Reed fragments adhere to the wet back but do not grow into decorative antlers. The creature feels heavy, frightened and physically damp.

SCALE & SURFACE

1.72 m height. canonical runtime height. waterlogged olive hide, peat-stained fibres, wet reed fragments, opaque amber core

ANIMATION / RIG

BIPED_BOG; broad body with belly and root attachments. bog_reach, root_hide, ash_recoil, core_exposed

ENCOUNTER

Early boss whose protected core teaches exposure and a clear punish window.

READ THE ATTACK

The back contracts, both hands drag furrows toward the player and the torso visibly compresses before bog_reach.

PLAYER ANSWER

Preserve the ash-bomb weakness: ash exposes its core and causes a retreat. Attack during the exposed interval, then reset outside the reach.

WHY IT BELONGS

The memory core is a required material link between the first investigation and the marsh's buried history.

ALTERNATIVE RESOLUTION

None in the current canonical encounter; peaceful_resolution is false. Fearful presentation adds context without inventing a peaceful quest bypass.

Gravebound Knight

Established creature / new visual design | Vargan Approach; sealed undercroft thresholds

VISUAL IDENTITY

A 1.88-metre undead sentinel enclosed in practical, corroded dark iron armor over funerary linen and exhausted mail. The helmet is a narrow enclosed sallet with an empty recessed visor, not a grinning skull. Clay and root grit pack the joints; missing armor plates reveal bound linen around an insubstantial body rather than exposed viscera. One square shoulder plate and a tall battered shield create an unmistakable vertical silhouette. Its long straight sword has a functional crossguard and a nicked edge. Broken oath cords are tied at the belt in short, weighted lengths. The feet are planted and weight-bearing, with no floating parts or arbitrary magical jewelry.

SCALE & SURFACE

1.88 m height. canonical runtime height. pitted dark iron, worn mail, burial linen, clay, oath cord

ANIMATION / RIG

BIPED_ARMORED; ordinary sentinel, separate from Halvern character asset. guard_raise, oath_test, shield_turn, sword_commit

ENCOUNTER

Threshold guard that teaches patience, flank access and armor preparation.

READ THE ATTACK

The shield locks in place and the sword rises to a clearly held guard before a deliberately committed cut.

PLAYER ANSWER

Preserve rot_oil as the weakness. Draw out the held attack, move around the shield and punish recovery without attacking continuously into guard.

WHY IT BELONGS

Makes sealed authority physically legible and distinguishes a rote enforced order from Halvern's deliberate refusal.

ALTERNATIVE RESOLUTION

Optional threshold recognition is a proposal only; the canonical ordinary sentinel is not the same encounter as Halvern's peaceful testimony duel.

The Bell-Eater

Established creature / new visual design | Greyfen cemetery

VISUAL IDENTITY

A 3.8-metre cemetery giant whose bowed humanlike frame carries the impossible weight of an old bronze chapel bell. The cracked bell hangs against the lower rib cage on a clearly engineered iron harness; its rim is chipped where the creature has bitten it. A small elongated head rises behind the collar, with a swollen resonant throat, closed pale eyes and heavy split lips. Long muscular arms carry loose working chains that visibly connect to the harness. Cold clay-grey flesh is stretched over the upper ribs but thickens around the hips and feet. Grave mud and green-black bronze patina provide texture; there are no ornamental horns, skull crowns or random dangling bones.

SCALE & SURFACE

3.8 m height. canonical runtime height. old bronze bell, forged iron harness, taut clay-grey flesh, grave mud, chain links

ANIMATION / RIG

GIANT_BIPED_BELL; secondary bell suspension and controlled chain joints. chain_sweep, bell_shockwave, grave_slam, ghoulkin_call

ENCOUNTER

Cemetery boss with Harnessed, Unchained and Hollow Bell phases.

READ THE ATTACK

Chain tension precedes the sweep; the bell visibly tilts before a grave-grown shockwave; both hands release outward before the Ghoulkin call.

PLAYER ANSWER

Preserve moon_oil weakness and the silence interruption to summons. Respect the chain sweep, read the grave shockwave path and commit during the recovery after a slam.

WHY IT BELONGS

Silencing the cemetery bell yields bell iron and the chapel key, making a major route and evidence transition tangible.

ALTERNATIVE RESOLUTION

None in the current canonical encounter; peaceful_resolution is false.

Rootbound Colossus

Established creature / new visual design | Deep Wood memory clearing

VISUAL IDENTITY

A 4.4-metre giant formed from compacted roots and a split old trunk, with a believable load path through two short pillar legs and enormous buttress forearms. The head is a low blunt knot sunk between the shoulders, with two dark sensory hollows and no carved human face. Broad bark plates overlap across the chest; a vertical seam reveals a dense amber heartwood core only when opened. Fine root hairs gather near the feet, while larger load-bearing roots twist around hips and elbows. Ash is worked into the wood grain and moss collects in sheltered recesses. The crown is broken and broad, never a stag skull or decorative antler rack.

SCALE & SURFACE

4.4 m height. canonical runtime height. split heartwood, layered bark, compacted roots, ash-filled grain, sheltered moss

ANIMATION / RIG

GIANT_ROOT_BIPED; rigid bark plates over deforming root bundles. root_lanes, ground_rupture, heart_stagger, root_plant

ENCOUNTER

Spatial boss whose root lanes and exposed-heart recovery teach deliberate repositioning.

READ THE ATTACK

The planted hand spreads distinct root ridges along the ground; the centre remains visibly open before the lane attack.

PLAYER ANSWER

Preserve oathfire weakness and the readable central gap. Move between lanes, avoid the rupture, then attack the opened heart during the stagger.

WHY IT BELONGS

Clears access to the reconstruction of the burned register and provides the oathwood core, so its defeat changes the investigation route.

ALTERNATIVE RESOLUTION

None in the current canonical encounter; peaceful_resolution is false.

Ashwing Carrion Drake

Established creature / new visual design | Old Mill marsh edge; mill roof and perch

VISUAL IDENTITY

A great carrion drake, 4.8 metres in its canonical posed height, with two powerful hind legs and a pair of forelimbs extended into broad leathery wings. Its chest is deep, its hooked head blunt and scavenger-like, and its long tail balances a low perch. Charcoal scales grade into wrinkled bare throat skin and thin soot-brown wing membranes with visible load-bearing fingers. Pale ash cakes sheltered scale seams; the wing edges show repaired tears rather than ornamental tatters. An expandable throat pouch precedes breath attacks. The body has no separate extra pair of arms, no crown of horns and no bright jewel-like eyes. Everything supports flight, perching and carrion feeding.

SCALE & SURFACE

4.8 m height; 8.5 m proposed wingspan. canonical runtime posed height. charcoal scales, leathery wing membrane, bare throat skin, pale mill ash, worn keratin claws

ANIMATION / RIG

DRAKE_WYVERN; two hind legs plus two wing forelimbs. perch, wing_blast, ash_breath, swoop

ENCOUNTER

A directional-pressure boss with perch destruction and grounded vulnerability.

READ THE ATTACK

The head aligns before ash breath, the forward wing raises before wing pressure, and both feet compress against the perch before a swoop.

PLAYER ANSWER

Preserve oathfire weakness. Move out of the directed breath and wing lanes, break the perch, then exploit its exposed grounded recovery.

WHY IT BELONGS

Breaks open the mill's physical concealment and yields drake ash and the mill seal, connecting the local food economy to the investigation.

ALTERNATIVE RESOLUTION

None in the current canonical encounter; peaceful_resolution is false.

White Hart Avatar

Established creature / new visual design | White Hart Glade; the road's bound memory

VISUAL IDENTITY

A great white stag, 3.6 metres at the canonical runtime height, with long weight-bearing legs, a deep cervine chest and a solemn, wholly animal face. Short ivory fur is stained grey around the hooves and lower flanks. Its antlers rise from plausible pedicles into broad, uneven tines, worn smooth along old contact points; they are neither tree branches nor a floating crown. Dark eyes are clear and watchful, with almost no emissive glow. Thin ash-like seams interrupt the flank fur as if an old wound had healed into the coat. The neck and shoulders carry real muscle beneath the softness. No armor, jewelry, human hands or extra eyes.

SCALE & SURFACE

3.6 m height. canonical runtime height; model bounds must specify antler inclusion. short ivory fur, weathered antler, black hoof, ash-grey scar seams

ANIMATION / RIG

CERVID_HART; quadruped with antler clearance and neck controls. witness_still, memory_echo, antler_sweep, mercy_lower

ENCOUNTER

Final witness and moral culmination; physical confrontation and a peaceful resolution are both already supported.

READ THE ATTACK

A still head turn precedes a memory echo; the neck lowers and the front hoof marks the ground before the antler sweep.

PLAYER ANSWER

Preserve moon_oil weakness for combat. The narrative route must respect truthful names and reject a false oath; do not reduce the finale to harvesting a boss drop.

WHY IT BELONGS

Provides the complete witness needed for the final oath and the road reopening; every earlier fragment gains context here.

ALTERNATIVE RESOLUTION

Witness and Mercy are releases accepted by the Hart; Duty is voluntary containment; Ash is destruction by force. Recovered human proof survives all four.

Silt-Maw

New creature proposal | Greyfen drainage banks; Old Mill sluice deposits

VISUAL IDENTITY

A muscular limbless predator about 3.2 metres long, with the low wedge-shaped head of a digging amphibian and a thick body that tapers into a blunt steering tail. Slate-brown skin is divided by shallow annular folds; the upper surface is tough and sand-scoured while the belly is pale and smooth. Tiny protected eyes sit behind ridged nostrils. Two short lateral jaw plates fold shut into the shovel-shaped snout, concealing compact teeth until feeding. Fine tactile pores ring the nose. There are no frills, horns or tentacles. Wet sediment hangs naturally from the lower folds, making its mass and underground movement easy to understand.

SCALE & SURFACE

3.2 m length; 0.55 m body height. proposed design target. sand-scoured skin, smooth pale belly, mud, small keratin jaw plates

ANIMATION / RIG

SERPENT_BURROWER; spline body with jaw and soil-entry controls. burrow_enter, burrow_exit, vibration_listen, eruption

ENCOUNTER

Burrow ambush with terrain reading and a route-repair objective.

READ THE ATTACK

A moving raised silt ridge slows and forms a circular mound before the snout breaks the surface.

PLAYER ANSWER

Step off the vibrating plank route onto firm stone, bait an eruption at an empty marked point, then strike the exposed flank during its turn.

WHY IT BELONGS

Its blocked burrow exposes a displaced drainage grate and a sealed packet, making water management and the movement of evidence one playable problem.

ALTERNATIVE RESOLUTION

Open the old sluice and guide it toward a deeper sediment bed, restoring drainage without killing it.

Millback

New creature proposal | Old Mill sluice; Greyfen river crossings

VISUAL IDENTITY

A broad freshwater crustacean roughly 2.4 metres across, held low above the riverbed on six jointed walking legs. Two compact front claws fold beneath a ridged oval carapace, giving it a heavy shield-like silhouette rather than a towering crab shape. The shell is dark mineral blue with limestone abrasion, worn brown growth rings and patches of attached river weed. Short stalked eyes retract into protected sockets. The mouthparts are small and practical; no monstrous human teeth. One shell edge is visibly polished by contact with the mill wheel. The legs have consistent joints and paddle-like terminal segments for pushing through fast water.

SCALE & SURFACE

2.4 m width; 0.8 m height. proposed design target. mineral-stained chitin, limestone abrasion, river weed, wet joint membrane

ANIMATION / RIG

CRUSTACEAN_EIGHT_APPENDAGES; six walking limbs plus two claws. side_shove, claw_brace, shell_lift, channel_enter

ENCOUNTER

Armor-facing puzzle around the working sluice and a moving wheel.

READ THE ATTACK

Both claws plant into the riverbed and the back lifts before a short sideways shove.

PLAYER ANSWER

Avoid the frontal carapace, redirect water to expose the soft leg joints and attack only after its shove commits.

WHY IT BELONGS

Restoring the mill's water flow changes food production and opens an inspection route into the waste channel; recovered refuse can be compared with the mill evidence.

ALTERNATIVE RESOLUTION

Reopen a side channel and bait it with ordinary mill waste so the wheel can turn again.

Glassmoth

New creature proposal | Wychwood; Record Hall eaves

VISUAL IDENTITY

A nocturnal moth with a 2.1-metre wingspan, four overlapping translucent wings and a compact furred body. The wing membranes are smoky pearl with large clear windows framed by dark, sharply organized veins. Thick charcoal thoracic hair protects the wing roots; six small legs fold neatly beneath the body. Two asymmetrical comb-like antennae are broad enough to identify it at game distance. The abdomen is pale and softly segmented, with dusty ochre scales gathering near the tip. Its face remains an insect head with compound eyes and a curled feeding tube. There are no skull patterns, human eyes or neon bioluminescent symbols.

SCALE & SURFACE

2.1 m wingspan; 0.7 m body length. proposed design target. translucent veined membrane, charcoal thoracic hair, powdery scales, smooth chitin

ANIMATION / RIG

LEPIDOPTERA; four wing controls, six small legs, antenna secondary motion. hover, land, dust_windup, dust_release

ENCOUNTER

Light-guided navigation and a short dust-pressure encounter that rewards restraint.

READ THE ATTACK

It folds the clear wing windows shut, raises the abdomen and shakes the antennae before releasing dust.

PLAYER ANSWER

Move into a crosswind or behind solid cover; use a steady directed light to redirect flight without a permanent screen-blind effect.

WHY IT BELONGS

Its attraction to a specific sealing wax helps locate a concealed record shipment and introduces a practical connection between the forest and archive trade.

ALTERNATIVE RESOLUTION

Move a lantern to a safe resin lure and lead the moth away from the record storage entrance.

Knell Leech

New creature proposal | Greyfen flooded crypt; undercroft drains

VISUAL IDENTITY

A thick, flattened leech roughly 1.8 metres long, with overlapping circular muscle bands and two clearly different suction discs. The broad front disc has a dense radial mouth whose small teeth appear only when the disc opens; the rear disc is a simple anchoring pad. Dull plum-black skin shines only on its wet lower edge, while the upper back is roughened by fine mineral grit. Pale pressure marks separate the rings. Tiny sensory pits run along the front third of the body; there are no eyes on stalks, limbs or decorative spikes. Its shape changes through believable muscular compression instead of stretching like rubber.

SCALE & SURFACE

1.8 m length; 0.45 m width. proposed design target. wet annelid skin, mineral grit, radial keratin mouthparts

ANIMATION / RIG

ANNELID_LATCHER; segmented spline with two suction controls. rear_anchor, compress_windup, disc_lunge, latch_release

ENCOUNTER

Ceiling-to-floor ambush that teaches checking overhead and interrupting a latch before contact.

READ THE ATTACK

Its rear disc anchors and the body shortens into visible accordion folds before the front disc releases toward a target.

PLAYER ANSWER

Break line of approach with a pillar or interrupt the exposed front disc during its windup. A short, readable latch escape replaces extended control loss.

WHY IT BELONGS

The infestation reveals a functioning drain beneath a supposedly sealed crypt, establishing a physical route by which objects were moved.

ALTERNATIVE RESOLUTION

Drain the affected pipe run and redirect vibration to an empty sump, clearing a safe passage.

Hearthscale

New creature proposal | Vargan Approach lime kilns; Old Mill ash yards

VISUAL IDENTITY

A heavy four-legged reptile about 2.7 metres from nose to tail, with a broad closed snout, short muscular neck and strongly planted clawed feet. The back carries interlocking dark mineralized plates, large near the shoulders and smaller toward a thick tapering tail. Warm clay-orange skin is visible in flexible folds beneath the plates. The throat has a pair of broad heat-dispersing creases; the eyes are small and golden-brown. Scales are chipped and dulled by kiln rubble, with pale dust in the seams. It has no volcanic cracks, glowing lava veins or flames issuing from its body. Heat is conveyed through breath, posture and environment.

SCALE & SURFACE

2.7 m length; 0.85 m shoulder height. proposed design target. mineralized dorsal plates, clay-orange scale skin, kiln dust, worn claws

ANIMATION / RIG

QUADRUPED_REPTILE; heavy tail and throat expansion controls. heat_rest, throat_expand, grit_exhale, tail_brace

ENCOUNTER

Armor-direction and environmental temperature encounter around a working kiln.

READ THE ATTACK

Its throat creases open, the front feet brace and the tail lifts before a hot grit exhalation.

PLAYER ANSWER

Stay out of the cone, force a turn around solid masonry and strike the unarmored lower flank after the exhalation.

WHY IT BELONGS

Reopening the kiln restores a local craft supply and reveals material residues needed to distinguish ordinary industrial ash from the mill's contested deposits.

ALTERNATIVE RESOLUTION

Move its heat source to an abandoned kiln using the vent controls, allowing workers to recover the active yard.

Gallows Weaver

New creature proposal | Wychwood abandoned gallows track; Vargan roadside structures

VISUAL IDENTITY

A large spider with a 2.6-metre leg spread, eight thin but mechanically credible legs and a pear-shaped abdomen marked with dull weathered bands. Its front body is compact and low, with eight small eyes clustered naturally above modest downward chelicerae. Fine dark bristles catch dew along the joints; the abdomen is softer, grey-brown and slightly wrinkled. Two rear spinnerets are visible beneath the body. Old cloth fibres and bark dust cling to the web around it, not to a costume on the creature. There are no human faces, skull markings, extra arms or huge exposed fangs. Its silhouette depends on arch and tension, not gore.

SCALE & SURFACE

2.6 m leg spread; 0.9 m body height. proposed design target. bristled chitin, soft abdominal skin, dew, silk

ANIMATION / RIG

ARACHNID_EIGHT_LEGS; body suspension and paired leg cycles. web_climb, silk_cast, pounce, anchor_fail

ENCOUNTER

Anchor-cutting traversal and an arena whose geometry can be deliberately changed.

READ THE ATTACK

The front pair of legs lift and the abdomen contracts before a visible silk cast; a pounce begins with all rear legs compressing.

PLAYER ANSWER

Cut clearly marked anchor strands to limit its overhead routes, sidestep the cast, and strike during landing recovery.

WHY IT BELONGS

Reopens an old execution route and preserves a lost transport tag in silk, tying an optional encounter to a bounded human history.

ALTERNATIVE RESOLUTION

Create an alternate anchored web path away from the road, then retrieve a cache after it relocates.

Reed Choir

New creature proposal | Greyfen reed beds; Old Mill marsh

VISUAL IDENTITY

A squat amphibian roughly 1.5 metres wide, supported by two short front legs and powerful folded hind legs. Three soft resonance sacs rise along its back like uneven closed bellows, visibly connected to the chest rather than floating bulbs. The head is broad and flat with lateral copper-brown eyes, a simple closed mouth and paired nostril ridges. Pebbled olive skin becomes pale grey across the throat and belly. Dry reed fragments collect in a shallow groove behind the shoulders. The sacs are translucent only at their thinnest stretched edges, revealing no organs. Its body should look heavy, damp and capable of a sudden short hop.

SCALE & SURFACE

1.5 m width; 0.6 m resting height; 1.2 m inflated height. proposed design target. pebbled amphibian skin, stretched sac membrane, dry reeds, marsh water

ANIMATION / RIG

AMPHIBIAN_SQUAT; four limbs plus three controlled resonance sacs. sac_sequence, pressure_call, short_hop, water_listen

ENCOUNTER

Timed pressure pulses and a navigational clue through marsh water routes.

READ THE ATTACK

The three sacs inflate in a fixed sequence before a broad pressure call; ripples travel outward from the feet.

PLAYER ANSWER

Move behind solid reeds-and-bank cover before the final sac fills, or disturb the water at a safe alternate location to redirect attention.

WHY IT BELONGS

The chorus reveals which channels remain connected and lets the player trace a hidden water route; restoring spawning access changes village travel conditions.

ALTERNATIVE RESOLUTION

Reopen the blocked spawning channel and guide the chorus away from the settlement's crossing.

Inkblind

New creature proposal | Record Hall stores; undercroft document vault

VISUAL IDENTITY

A flightless beetle about 1.2 metres long, with a blunt wedge-shaped carapace that fits between storage shelves. Six short jointed legs hold the body close to the floor. Its head has no visible eyes; two long segmented feelers sweep ahead of a pair of folding brush-like feeding palps. Matte black-brown shell plates are polished at the edges by repeated contact with wood. Pale paper dust gathers around the mouth and front legs, while old ink stains mark the underside in irregular grey-blue patches. The back remains a continuous solid shield, with no oversized spikes, skull markings or decorative wings.

SCALE & SURFACE

1.2 m length; 0.35 m height. proposed design target. matte chitin, paper dust, ink-stained cuticle, fine feeding brushes

ANIMATION / RIG

INSECT_SIX_LEGS; compact beetle with antenna and palp controls. paste_feed, antenna_align, short_charge, lure_follow

ENCOUNTER

Quiet navigation and document rescue under local pressure, with a visible feeding process.

READ THE ATTACK

Both antennae align on a vibration source and the palps close before a short head-first charge.

PLAYER ANSWER

Stop moving on resonant shelving, use an ordinary paste lure, or sidestep a charge into an empty aisle. Do not create irreversible main-quest document loss.

WHY IT BELONGS

Makes archive neglect a material problem and reveals a recently pasted false backing through selective feeding; the document still requires human examination.

ALTERNATIVE RESOLUTION

Set paste lures and dry the damaged storage bay, relocating the beetles while preserving the records.

Cairn Mother

New creature proposal | Hart Glade margins; abandoned Greyfen cairn paths

VISUAL IDENTITY

An enormous land mollusc, 3.5 metres long, whose muscular foot carries a heavy, low spiral shell. Mineral deposits have grown into broad uneven layers around the shell rather than a pile of balanced loose rocks. The exposed body is dark slate and finely pebbled, with a pale travelling edge pressed firmly to the ground. Two long upper feelers carry small dark eyes; two shorter lower feelers test the soil. Old lichen grows only on sheltered shell surfaces. The mouth is a modest fold beneath the head, not a ring of monstrous fangs. Its slow, continuous movement and visible load-bearing foot make the creature feel ancient and physical.

SCALE & SURFACE

3.5 m length; 1.9 m shell height. proposed design target. layered mineral shell, slate mollusc skin, lichen, damp soil

ANIMATION / RIG

MOLLUSC_GRAZER; foot deformation, neck and four feeler controls. graze, feeler_test, shell_lower, soil_push

ENCOUNTER

A moving obstruction and stewardship choice, with defensive rather than predatory aggression.

READ THE ATTACK

The feelers retract and the shell lowers before the creature pushes a wide defensive ring of soil outward.

PLAYER ANSWER

Give it space, remain outside the broad push and avoid standing against its shell. Combat is possible but slow and materially wasteful.

WHY IT BELONGS

Opens an old cairn route and provides a dated embedded boundary marker, making land use and the age of a disputed path visible.

ALTERNATIVE RESOLUTION

Restore its mineral feeding path and guide it away from the trail, then inspect a naturally loosened shell deposit.

Shroud Swimmer

New creature proposal | Old Mill deep pools; Greyfen flooded crossings

VISUAL IDENTITY

A broad freshwater ray, 2.8 metres across, with a low diamond-shaped disc and a long unbarbed balancing tail. The upper skin is silt-brown with fine irregular speckling; its pale underside folds like damp cloth only at the flexible wing edges. Two raised eyes and paired breathing openings sit naturally above the head. The mouth and gill slits remain on the underside, anatomically separated from the eyes. Small scars and worn edges indicate years in shallow channels. It has no human face, cloth costume, hovering ghost aura or ornamental horns. Its wide pectoral fins undulate in a slow continuous wave that can become a sudden burst.

SCALE & SURFACE

2.8 m disc width; 4.0 m total length. proposed design target. fine rough ray skin, pale flexible underside, silt, water sheen

ANIMATION / RIG

RAY_AQUATIC; paired fin deformation and tail spline. silt_bury, disc_raise, sediment_surge, net_struggle

ENCOUNTER

Shallow-water displacement encounter with visible surface trails and a rescue alternative.

READ THE ATTACK

The buried disc raises a sharp diamond ridge and both wing tips curl before a forward sediment surge.

PLAYER ANSWER

Move onto firm elevated footing, allow the surge to pass and approach from the side during its slow turn. Avoid punishing the player with unreadable underwater attacks.

WHY IT BELONGS

A trapped net preserves a deliberately weighted cargo bundle; freeing the animal recovers the bundle and makes the crossing safe.

ALTERNATIVE RESOLUTION

Cut the abandoned net and reopen its deep-water route, allowing it to leave the crossing.

Wychwood Raider

Established creature / new visual design | Wychwood road evidence clearings

VISUAL IDENTITY

A 1.86-metre beast with a narrow waist, high forward shoulders and long hooking hands adapted to snatching objects. Its head has a blunt keratin-edged muzzle, small lateral dark eyes and a tight closed mouth, distinct from the Ghoulkin's oversized jaw. Sparse coarse brown hair breaks across olive-grey hide in irregular patches. One shoulder is visibly higher from old healed injury; the arms remain anatomically complete and balanced. Short, backward-folding ears sit close to the skull. The feet are broad and gripping. A few name-token cords are caught around one wrist as accidental trophies, not clothing or a fantasy bandit outfit. No weapons, armor, tusk crown or decorative horns.

SCALE & SURFACE

1.86 m height. canonical runtime height. olive-grey hide, coarse brown hair, keratin muzzle edge, caught cord fragments

ANIMATION / RIG

BIPED_RAIDER; long fingers and asymmetric but fully functional shoulder pose. body_feint, token_grab, grab_miss, cache_drop

ENCOUNTER

Feinter that teaches recognition of a false opening and protection of carried evidence.

READ THE ATTACK

One shoulder dips in a false body attack; the true grab follows only when the wrist opens and both feet commit forward.

PLAYER ANSWER

Preserve normal-sword weakness. Hold through the first feint, sidestep the committed grab and punish the long recovery. Unique quest tokens remain recoverable.

WHY IT BELONGS

Makes the power of named personal objects active in play and creates a recoverable trail to a displaced token cache.

ALTERNATIVE RESOLUTION

Proposed incidental diversion uses a duplicate ordinary name tag or established decoy; never sacrifice irreplaceable evidence or bypass a required encounter.

Wychwood Brute

Established creature / new visual design | Wychwood blocked clearing routes

VISUAL IDENTITY

A 1.98-metre forest brute whose breadth matters more than height. A low heavy head sits forward beneath a continuous muscular shoulder mound; the thick neck nearly disappears into the torso. Its broad muzzle has two short worn lateral tusks, useful for pushing and breaking rather than forming a crown. Charcoal-olive hide is rough and folded over the shoulders, with paler stretched skin at the elbows and knees. Massive forearms end in blunt three-fingered load-bearing hands with an opposing thumb. Short powerful legs and broad feet make its centre of gravity credible. Embedded bark grit and healed impact scars communicate route-breaking work. No armor, club, chains or decorative spikes.

SCALE & SURFACE

1.98 m height; 1.25 m proposed shoulder width. canonical runtime height. rough charcoal-olive hide, worn tusk keratin, bark grit, healed impact scars

ANIMATION / RIG

BIPED_BRUTE; broad torso and short heavy limbs with planted contact poses. clearing_arrival, wide_plant, route_slam, obstruction_break

ENCOUNTER

Space-controlling heavy that tests commitment and route awareness rather than chase speed.

READ THE ATTACK

Both feet stamp into a wide base and the forearms pull together before a downward route-breaking slam.

PLAYER ANSWER

Preserve ash_bomb weakness. Bait the slam into the intended breakable obstruction, step out of the impact lane and attack during the visible recovery.

WHY IT BELONGS

Turns blocked routes into part of the encounter and reveals what the obstruction concealed after the brute's committed attack.

ALTERNATIVE RESOLUTION

Avoiding the defended clearing may be possible in optional placement; do not invent a peaceful completion of an existing mandatory combat objective.

Sister Anwen

Established character / new visual design | Greyfen shrine and cemetery

VISUAL IDENTITY

A forty-six-year-old woman with weather-paled olive skin, a long alert face, uneven brows and clear tired eyes. Fine lines remain around the eyes and mouth. Pale blonde-grey hair is braided and pinned low, exposing the entire face. A repaired slate-blue wool outer gown sits over warm unbleached linen, with a dark ash-grey shoulder shawl, secured sleeves and practical ankle boots. The narrow leather belt carries a small dull bell token and a folded cloth. Her plain ash staff is held beside the body, its grip polished by years of use. Her posture offers attention without a saintly pose or youthful glamour.

PERSON

Keep the shrine useful to frightened living people without allowing protection to become another demand for silence. She knows care is freely offered yet has repeatedly managed other people's knowledge for their supposed safety.

SIGNATURE & SCALE

Dull bell token; plain ash staff with an established hand attachment. 1.68 m height. Existing target height

ESTABLISHED STORY

Forty-six years old; not personally responsible for the original massacre thirty-two years ago. Tied burial thread around recovered names; failed containment and later concealment are her present responsibility.

FORWARD ARC / PROPOSED

Builds a consent-led sanctuary with treatment and shelter available regardless of ritual participation; the aftermath tests whether an institution can surrender control while remaining useful.

PERFORMANCE

Attentive stillness, restrained nod, a small self-correction before an admission, cup offered from an actual hand socket.

ONE POSSIBLE LINE

You may keep your name to yourself. The blanket is still yours.

CONNECTED TO

Mira Fen, Oren Vey, Record Keeper Vale

Rook

Established character / new visual design | Greyfen market and road routes

VISUAL IDENTITY

A slender twenty-nine-year-old man with medium brown skin, a quick crooked smile, prominent cheekbones and closely curled black hair flattened on one side by a travel cap. His reed-green wool coat is cut short enough for cart work, repaired with darker panels, and worn over a faded linen shirt and narrow brown trousers. A doubled road knot hangs from his belt beside a flat map case, never like a magical talisman. Boots have mismatched old repairs. Long expressive fingers and a shifting, observant stance distinguish him from the stiller cast. He looks capable of carrying goods and getting caught laughing at an inconvenient moment.

PERSON

Keep roads usable and family testimony in the hands of those who must live with its exposure. His useful discretion can become an excuse to leave other travelers without the route they need.

SIGNATURE & SCALE

Doubled road knot and flat, rain-stained map case. 1.75 m height. Proposed

ESTABLISHED STORY

Twenty-nine years old; he carries inherited testimony, not firsthand knowledge of the war. Remembers Bram's generosity, helps the opening cart, and jokes without becoming comic relief.

FORWARD ARC / PROPOSED

Becomes a negotiator between refugee routes and newly reopened trade; must decide which knowledge can be shared without turning safe paths into hunting maps.

PERFORMANCE

Hands start a joke then settle when someone becomes vulnerable; reads the listener before continuing.

ONE POSSIBLE LINE

I can tell you where the road goes. Where people hide is a different bargain.

CONNECTED TO

Bram Kett, Nessa, Nera

Mira Fen

Established character / new visual design | Greyfen herb garden and Wychwood

VISUAL IDENTITY

A proposed thirty-seven-year-old woman of compact, strong build with warm umber skin, broad cheeks, a softly squared nose and black hair gathered in a thick practical braid. Her olive wool sleeveless overdress is layered over a russet long-sleeved linen shift, with a faded sage work apron and firmly tied cuffs. Dirt collects naturally beneath the nails and at the apron hem rather than across the face. Pouches hold labelled cloth packets, a small wooden measure and bundled roots tied with plain ribbon. Her shoulders incline toward the task, not toward submissiveness. Clear, questioning eyes and a grounded stance convey professional care and discomfort with easy answers.

PERSON

Make care effective and honestly chosen even when the honest alternative takes longer. She distinguishes useful from consented in principle yet concealed where her most effective treatment came from.

SIGNATURE & SCALE

Tied root ribbon and wooden medicine measure. 1.61 m height. Proposed

ESTABLISHED STORY

Treats Toma's daughter's fever and remembers Oren's practical needs. Ash-fed roots made useful medicine while denying families informed choice.

FORWARD ARC / PROPOSED

Creates a replacement medicine garden and an apprentice practice; each crop shortage tests whether honest care survives scarcity.

PERFORMANCE

Counts portions, checks a label, asks before reaching toward another person's hand, breathes out after disclosure.

ONE POSSIBLE LINE

It works. That is the part I told them. It was not the whole answer.

CONNECTED TO

Farmer Toma, Sister Anwen, Nessa

Blacksmith Tor

Established character / new visual design | Greyfen forge and road works

VISUAL IDENTITY

A proposed fifty-one-year-old man with deep brown skin, a broad barrel chest, thick forearms and a close silver-black beard around a bald scalp. His face is open and square with one slightly drooping eyelid, a healed cheek nick and patient eyes. Charcoal wool trousers and an unbleached collarless shirt sit beneath a heavy split leather apron, patched at the thigh where hot scale lands. A plain iron ring and a short working hammer are his only adornments. Boots are wide and reinforced, not armored greaves. Charcoal dust follows the hands and apron rather than obscuring the anatomy. His stance is heavy, useful and unshowy.

PERSON

Leave behind work that can be used without requiring somebody else's story to be erased. His practical pride made provenance seem like someone else's problem.

SIGNATURE & SCALE

Plain iron ring and short working hammer. 1.82 m height. Proposed

ESTABLISHED STORY

Keeps hinges, tools, carts and roads working; gives useful scrap. Ground off refugee ownership marks for convenience.

FORWARD ARC / PROPOSED

Organizes apprentices and clean scrap supply; must resist a profitable commission that would consume the metal promised for safe roads.

PERFORMANCE

Checks heat before gripping metal; puts the hammer down before difficult speech.

ONE POSSIBLE LINE

A hinge can be sound and still be stolen. I know how to mend only one of those with a hammer.

CONNECTED TO

Widow Elna, Farmer Toma, Steward Merrow

Widow Elna

Established character / new visual design | Greyfen home and cemetery

VISUAL IDENTITY

A proposed seventy-one-year-old woman, short and narrow through the shoulders, with pale weathered skin, a prominent aquiline nose, sharp dark eyes and deeply settled smile lines. Iron-grey hair is twisted into a low coil, with loose strands kept out of her face by a plain linen band. A muted plum wool dress and ash-grey shawl are repeatedly repaired with fine, patient stitching. Her hands show age and skill, holding a neatly folded name packet in a small cloth sleeve. Sensible worn shoes remain visible beneath the hem. She is neither a frail prop nor a gothic widow: a straight-backed neighbor who still notices everything.

PERSON

Tell her family a whole account without allowing strangers to own her grief. The tenderness she remembers is true, and so is the harm her kinder story concealed.

SIGNATURE & SCALE

Folded name packet in a repaired cloth sleeve. 1.55 m height. Proposed

ESTABLISHED STORY

Loved Harl and remembers him warming shoes, including an embarrassing burned one. Harl kept his gate role private for years and died last winter.

FORWARD ARC / PROPOSED

Becomes a demanding editor of the village's memorial: accurate about responsibility and exact about whose personal memories may be printed.

PERFORMANCE

Long stillness, packet folded carefully, gaze lifted directly when challenged.

ONE POSSIBLE LINE

He was kind to me. Put that beside what he did, not over it.

CONNECTED TO

Harl, Blacksmith Tor, Record Keeper Vale

Farmer Toma

Established character / new visual design | Greyfen fold, fields and village supply route

VISUAL IDENTITY

A proposed thirty-nine-year-old man with a rangy frame, sun-reddened freckled skin, tired hazel eyes and a short uneven reddish-brown beard. His nose has been broken once and healed slightly off-center. A faded ochre tunic, grain-coloured sleeveless overvest and patched wool trousers show labor through wear at knees and cuffs. One simple canvas packet bears flour dust; a small utility knife is sheathed for farm work. Coarse hair falls forward despite being combed with water. His hands are broad and callused, his posture a little sleepless rather than weak. The silhouette is long and practical, clearly different from Tor's heavy forge build.

PERSON

Let his daughter sleep safely without making another family pay for that safety. He asks for neighbors' solidarity while withholding the danger they share.

SIGNATURE & SCALE

Flour-coloured packet and simple folded grain receipt. 1.79 m height. Proposed

ESTABLISHED STORY

A father with a feverish daughter; Mira provides care. Tends the fold and brings grain into village life.

FORWARD ARC / PROPOSED

Becomes the voice of households asked to support restitution while feeding children; proposes a seed reserve instead of another protective bargain.

PERFORMANCE

Checks the doorway while speaking; hands stop fidgeting only after a practical plan is made.

ONE POSSIBLE LINE

I wanted one quiet night for her. I stopped counting whose night it might cost.

CONNECTED TO

Mira Fen, Nessa, Nera

Captain Senn

Established character / new visual design | Bandit Road command clearing

VISUAL IDENTITY

A fifty-four-year-old man with a thick neck, a once-powerful frame gone slightly heavy, fair windburned skin and iron-grey hair cropped close. His jaw is broad, the mouth tight, and one ear is nicked rather than theatrically torn. A worn blue-grey military coat hangs over a repaired quilted jack, with a limited steel breastplate, sensible leather belt and knee-high mud-marked boots. The cut oath ribbon is visible at the breast; the old insignia has been unpicked. His sword is serviceable, not legendary. He stands with an officer's habitual economy, carrying pain in a guarded shoulder rather than in oversized armor or a permanent villain sneer.

PERSON

Make his suffering count as something more than obedience while retaining authority over the road. He demands recognition of past wrongs while committing present coercion.

SIGNATURE & SCALE

Cut military oath ribbon; service sword and plain scabbard. 1.83 m height. Proposed

ESTABLISHED STORY

Fifty-four; twenty-two-year-old officer during the massacre thirty-two years earlier. Closed the military retreat after Halvern refused.

FORWARD ARC / PROPOSED

If alive and present, he must do supervised repair labor and answer specific claims without converting service into pardon. Exile or death routes use his existing written record and other living workers.

PERFORMANCE

Hand leaves the sword when admitting responsibility; surrender is a clear authored state.

ONE POSSIBLE LINE

It was an order. I have said that so often it began to sound like an answer.

CONNECTED TO

Sir Halvern, Nera, Steward Merrow

Lord Edric Vargan

Established character / new visual design | Castle Vargan and Greyfen assembly

VISUAL IDENTITY

A forty-three-year-old man with light olive skin, carefully groomed dark hair receding at the temples, a neat short beard and observant grey-brown eyes. He is of average athletic build, neither kingly giant nor decadent caricature. A symmetrical charcoal wool doublet and long oxblood overcoat use expensive but subdued cloth, precise seams and restrained fastenings. A tarnished signet and seal case carry institutional weight without a crown. Clean practical boots and a discreet dagger fit a working lord who travels between storehouses and court. The face is courteous, controlled and increasingly tired, with an exact mouth that loses its rehearsed composure when the ration condition is named.

PERSON

Preserve a functioning region and the authority he believes is necessary to keep it functioning. He calls it stewardship when he determines what others may know and what promises hunger must buy.

SIGNATURE & SCALE

Tarnished seal with a worn leather seal case. 1.77 m height. Proposed

ESTABLISHED STORY

Forty-three; found and suppressed the command ledger six years ago. Releases real grain and maintains real protection; his competence is not a trick.

FORWARD ARC / PROPOSED

If cooperative, negotiates restitution without immunity. If exposed, remains a capable but contested supplier. If compelled, his facts survive while every future promise requires a new voluntary decision.

PERFORMANCE

Economical open hand, one glance toward the seal, then unadorned speech when authority fails.

ONE POSSIBLE LINE

The sacks are real. So are the terms. I see now why that does not defend me.

CONNECTED TO

Steward Merrow, Record Keeper Vale, Sister Anwen

Record Keeper Vale

Established character / new visual design | Vargan Record Hall

VISUAL IDENTITY

A proposed sixty-two-year-old woman with dark brown skin, a long broad-nosed face, deep forehead creases and tightly coiled silver hair cropped close around the head. Her pale attentive eyes sit behind no face-obscuring ornament. A smoke-indigo wool gown is belted beneath a faded parchment-coloured sleeveless tabard, with a narrow rust-red sleeve tie used to keep cuffs clear of ink. Her build is tall and spare, shoulders slightly forward from reading. Ink stains touch two fingertips; a flat archival key and folded page sit in separate leather pockets. Her clothing is carefully maintained rather than luxurious. She faces the viewer with exact, uncomfortable honesty.

PERSON

Make the archive trustworthy after realizing intact records are useless when access is withheld. She took pride in never destroying a page while helping the institution make those pages disappear from public life.

SIGNATURE & SCALE

Uncut archival page and flat drawer key. 1.73 m height. Proposed

ESTABLISHED STORY

Keeps Vargan's records. Lays an uncut page beneath a lamp and permits the hunter to read it.

FORWARD ARC / PROPOSED

Leads a mobile duplicate archive as institutions contest the record. Her major conflict becomes who can challenge, copy and correct public history without exposing vulnerable households.

PERFORMANCE

Aligns pages before speaking, then deliberately leaves a page within another person's reach.

ONE POSSIBLE LINE

I kept every page. That is not the same as letting anyone read them.

CONNECTED TO

Lord Edric Vargan, Widow Elna, Rook

Steward Merrow

Established character / new visual design | Vargan court and grain stores

VISUAL IDENTITY

A proposed fifty-year-old man with warm light-brown skin, a stocky pear-shaped build, thinning black hair around a bare crown and a closely trimmed moustache. Round watchful eyes and a broad soft jaw make him visibly ordinary rather than sinister. His muted tobacco wool coat has a short practical skirt, bottle-green cuffs and a pale work shirt; the cloth is good but creased from leaning over tables. A tally board, wax pencil and ring of plain store keys occupy separate belt loops. Boots carry flour dust. His hands sort objects into careful columns. Small signs of anxiety appear when the familiar columns no longer justify the decisions.

PERSON

Keep distribution predictable and prevent a queue from becoming a riot. He treats a legible rule as a fair rule and calls the suffering it creates an administrative exception.

SIGNATURE & SCALE

Grain tally board, wax pencil and storehouse keys. 1.67 m height. Proposed

ESTABLISHED STORY

Arranges sacks and petitions in the court's daily business. Explains that a supported household must witness the renewal under the current terms.

FORWARD ARC / PROPOSED

Becomes the central logistics character in reconstruction: his skill can build an accountable relief system, or his defensiveness can make a technically correct ledger another mechanism of exclusion.

PERFORMANCE

Sorts petitions automatically, catches himself when a person interrupts the routine, puts the tally down to listen.

ONE POSSIBLE LINE

I can tell you where every sack went. I have been avoiding who went without.

CONNECTED TO

Lord Edric Vargan, Nessa, Blacksmith Tor

Nessa

Established character / new visual design | Greyfen kitchen, bakery and arrival shelter

VISUAL IDENTITY

A proposed thirty-six-year-old woman with fair freckled skin, a broad round face, a small crooked nose, lively dark eyes and copper-red hair braided into a crown beneath a simple cream kerchief. Her strong full build communicates long hours lifting dough troughs and sacks. A faded terracotta wool skirt, rolled cream linen sleeves and indigo work bodice sit beneath a flour-marked canvas apron. One cuff has a careful blue repair. A bread knife stays safely sheathed; she carries a wooden peel and a plain weighing counterweight. Heat reddens her cheeks without glamorous makeup. Her posture is open, direct and difficult to intimidate.

PERSON

Make sure ordinary people can eat before leaders ask them to stand for anything. Her informal authority can become possessive when others offer help she cannot personally supervise.

SIGNATURE & SCALE

Wooden bread peel and a corrected counterweight. 1.65 m height. Proposed

ESTABLISHED STORY

Bakes for Greyfen and notices the same sack now makes nine loaves rather than twelve. Investigates diverted flour and a tampered scale without demanding a hungry neighbor be dragged through the square.

FORWARD ARC / PROPOSED

Builds a kitchen cooperative that can outlast charitable moods; becomes a major political voice because she can demonstrate what every proclamation does to the next day's bread.

PERFORMANCE

Brushes flour from a receipt, sets down food before asking a question, laughter returns naturally after disagreement.

ONE POSSIBLE LINE

Bring me the terms after breakfast. Hunger agrees with anything.

CONNECTED TO

Rook, Farmer Toma, Steward Merrow, Sister Anwen

Nera

Established character / new visual design | Marsh Crossing and Bandit Road approach

VISUAL IDENTITY

A proposed thirty-two-year-old woman with sun-darkened tawny skin, a broad angular face, deep-set black eyes and black hair cropped close at the back with a short practical braid above one ear. She is tall and wiry with developed shoulders and rope-worn palms. A weatherproof dark teal wool coat is split for movement over brown trousers and knee-high waxed leather boots. A short rust scarf, a coil of rescue rope, a hooded iron lantern and a notched signal baton create a strong readable silhouette. Repairs are tarred and stitched, never ornamental. Her gaze checks footing before faces; her stance remains ready to brace a load.

PERSON

Make a route someone else can understand from the far bank, even when she cannot be there to guide them. She wants reliable safety records but omitted the personal decision inside her most consequential failure.

SIGNATURE & SCALE

Cut rescue cord kept beside a newly coiled line; hooded lantern and notched signal baton. 1.8 m height. Proposed

ESTABLISHED STORY

Keeps the marsh crossing and its signal posts legible in daylight as well as darkness. Cut a rescue cord when it threatened to pull her in, then logged a crossing failure while omitting the knife.

FORWARD ARC / PROPOSED

Organizes an accountable crossing service as refugees and merchants return; the next crisis tests public safety methods that allow workers to stop rather than demand self-sacrifice.

PERFORMANCE

Tests a knot twice, turns lantern hood rather than waving it, looks up only once the load is secured.

ONE POSSIBLE LINE

A safe crossing is one you can find without trusting my voice.

CONNECTED TO

Captain Senn, Tavin, Rook, Nessa

From a sheet to an actor

1 / APPROVE THE DESIGN

Choose one actor and reconcile front, rear and detail views. Resolve the silhouette at real camera distance. Confirm scale, joints, costume construction, mouth/eye anatomy and prop attachments.

2 / BUILD THE SOURCE

Model and retopologize, create UVs, bake intentional maps, set materials, rig and weight the body, then author the required clips. A painting's highlights are not a base-color texture. Keep editable source files.

3 / PRESERVE THE PROJECT CONTRACT

Current AshenOath shared clips use in-place locomotion with root motion disabled. Retain actor IDs, quest bindings and contact behavior. Anwen's staff attaches to the correct hand; no accessory should obscure a broken face.

4 / EXPORT AND INSPECT

Use glTF 2.0/GLB for modeled actors, following Godot's recommended interchange route [G1]. Fix source geometry and weighting before import where practical [G2]. Inspect exact dimensions, handedness, transforms and animation names.

5 / VALIDATE IN THE GAME

Inspect the actor in the actual browser renderer and relevant playable route. Measure export bytes, cold-start time, memory and frame time. A native editor preview alone does not establish browser acceptance [G4].

ONE ACTOR AT A TIME

Suggested first tranche: Anwen, Ghoulkin, Stalker, Bog Wretch, Senn, Rook, Tor and Bell-Eater. This is a production priority, not a replacement of the project's existing acceptance process.

Runtime targets / proposed

BUDGET STATUS

These are starting art targets, not official engine limits or measured guarantees. The complete game's existing under-100-MiB release target remains the constraint. The reference archive is not a runtime payload.

FREQUENT CREATURES

6-12k triangles, one 1k texture set, 1-2 materials, approximately 30-50 deforming bones. Tune against actual simultaneous actor count and camera distance.

ELITES AND MAJOR NPCS

Elites: 12-20k triangles and one 1k-2k texture set. NPCs: 12-20k triangles, one 1k body set with an optional 1k face set; 2-3 materials. Prioritize face identity and deformation over invisible detail.

BOSSES

20-35k triangles and one 2k set initially, with 2-3 materials. Plan dedicated articulation for wings, bells, shells and other unusual anatomy. A shared rig is appropriate only when the joints and movement actually match.

MAPS AND MATERIALS

Use base color, tangent-space normal and packed occlusion/roughness/metallic only where supported by the receiving material contract. Prefer economical opaque materials. Distinguish cloth, skin, stone and metal through roughness and material response.

LOD AND BROWSER REVIEW

Godot can generate LODs during scene import, but skinned meshes can develop visual artifacts [G3]. Check faces, hands, straps, antlers and wing edges. Browser export uses Compatibility/WebGL 2 [G4]. Test materials there early.

Acceptance is visible

IDENTITY AND ANATOMY

Inspect all sides at dialogue and gameplay distances. Check eyes, teeth, mouth interior, neck seams, fingers, horns and equipment. Eliminate detached pieces and accidental duplicate surfaces.

MOTION AND CONTACT

Run extreme-pose checks. Feet plant, shoulders rotate, cloth clears joints and hands grip the intended object. Attacks have anticipation, active contact and recovery; death and disengagement stop damage.

MATERIALS AND DISTANCE

Check missing textures, normal direction, color-space handling, roughness and transparency. LOD transitions must preserve the silhouette and avoid facial or wing distortions.

QUEST AND INTERACTION

Preserve the existing actor identity, evidence, save flags, interaction placement and route requirements. Proposed peaceful resolutions must not silently bypass mandatory existing objectives.

PERFORMANCE AND PROVENANCE

Record the exact source/export revision, build-size delta, cold-load evidence, memory/frame-time impact and remaining defects. Keep generated concept provenance separate from model authorship and final user approval.

FULL HANDOFF

The archive includes the complete Production_Handoff.md, exact image prompts and all 32 dossiers. Every entry in asset_manifest.json identifies what actually exists. Runtime model, rig and animation status remain unproduced.

Grounded in AshenOath

PROJECT SOURCE

RafaTahir/AshenOath, codex/masterpiece-rebuild. Observed source commit 08e5ef4b21dd75c1c90708c307de51f9a3812da0. Read-only source audit on 29 October 2026. The complete source mapping and canonical constraints are recorded in data/canon_audit.json.

CANONICAL FILES

STORY_ART_AND_SOUND_BIBLE.md; author_story_docs.py; data/journal_people.json; data/cast_life.json; data/campaign_dialogue.json; character role and monster family manifests. Exact source locations are in the audit.

G1 / MODEL INTERCHANGE

Godot Engine 4.6: Available 3D formats. docs.godotengine.org/en/4.6/tutorials/assets_pipeline/importing_3d_scenes/available_formats.html

G2 / IMPORT WORKFLOW

Godot Engine 4.6: Import configuration. docs.godotengine.org/en/4.6/tutorials/assets_pipeline/importing_3d_scenes/import_configuration.html

G3 / DISTANCE DETAIL

Godot Engine 4.6: Mesh level of detail. docs.godotengine.org/en/4.6/tutorials/3d/mesh_lod.html

G4 / BROWSER RENDERING

Godot Engine 4.6: Exporting for the Web. docs.godotengine.org/en/4.6/tutorials/export/exporting_for_web.html

ART PROVENANCE

Each illustration was generated individually with the built-in image-generation tool using an original brief. Exact prompts, original-resolution images and checksums are included. New designs and forward arcs are proposals. No extracted Witcher models or textures are included. Final game art acceptance remains with Rafa.